CSS Foundations

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Foundations

- About CSS
- Using CSS
- Properties & Values
- Selectors
- Specificity
- Combinators

Agenda

Cascading Style Sheets

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What are CSS?

- they are optional (HTML is required)
- allow you to style HTML
- make your HTML look good
- "cascading" → multiple rules apply to same element

History

- CSS 1 (1996)
- CSS 2 (1998)
- CSS 3 (current)
  - in development – forever ☺

Using CSS

- Inline styling
  - Rules via style[attribute] <element style="" />
- Via selector
  - Put rules into <style> tag or
  - External stylesheet file(s) .css
- What's the best way & why?

Properties & Values

- property: value
- property-a: value-a; property-b: value-b
- a lot of properties!
  - https://www.w3schools.com/cssref/
  - https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/CSS_Properties_Reference
- we don't have to know them all ☺

Values

- pre-defined
  - display: block;
  - margin: auto;
- colors
  - black & white
  - #000000 & #fff
- numbers
  - margin: 16px / 1em / 1rem
  - width: 100%
- functions
  - scale(50%)

Selectors (in JS → Query Selectors)

- *
- element
- .class
- #id (only applicable once)
- [attribute=value] or just [disabled]
- :hover, :focus, :nth-child(2n + 1), (pseudo-class)
  - :not(...)
- ::after, ::before (pseudo-element)

Specificity (priorities)

use only if no other option

use rarely

!important

inline styles

#id

.class, :pseudo and [attr]

<element> and ::after

https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Specificity

Inheritance

- Styling the <body> tag
- property: inherit
  - explicitly override current element's styling with parent's styling

Combinators (increase specifity)

- .class-a.class-b (more specific)
- " " Descendant like div p {}
- > Direct child div > p {}
- ~ General sibling div ~ p {} ← following
- + Adjacent sibling div + p {} ← immediately following

https://developer.mozilla.org/.../Combinators_and_multiple_selectors

Demo

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Best Practices

- Use .class (not #id) to make styles reusable
- Use zero values without units
- Try to avoid !important

Tips

Foundations

- Rules
- Properties & Values
- Selectors
- Specificity
- Combinators

Summary

Questions?

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